NEXUS-IR | Find Evil! SANS 2026

Session: 20260523_142436 Generated: 2026-05-23 14:24 UTC Duration: 2.38s Version: 4.0.0-langgraph

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Threat Level:	**CRITICAL 100/100**
Case Priority:	CRITICAL
Files Scanned:	6
Attack Patterns:	3
IPs Identified:	2
Findings Valid:	37
Findings Rejected:	0
Confidence:	HIGH
Auto-Remediated:	0 pattern(s) injected by devil advocate
LangGraph Iters:	1

CHAIN OF CUSTODY -- EVIDENCE INTEGRITY

File:	sysmon_execution.json
SHA256:	619304a909d0de9741ac108a2ac53e2d366788677f5f7b66c59bdd492bb6a786
Size:	914 bytes
Hashed at:	2026-05-23T14:24:38.05332
File:	sysmon_execution.log
SHA256:	619304a909d0de9741ac108a2ac53e2d366788677f5f7b66c59bdd492bb6a786
Size:	914 bytes
Hashed at:	2026-05-23T14:24:38.05456
File:	sysmon_injection.json
SHA256:	670fa5d537a5337b60c444b935c93dbcb1129f404bcd8fef7d95d15b19246d00
Size:	915 bytes
Hashed at:	2026-05-23T14:24:38.05552
File:	sysmon_injection.log
SHA256:	670fa5d537a5337b60c444b935c93dbcb1129f404bcd8fef7d95d15b19246d00
Size:	915 bytes
Hashed at:	2026-05-23T14:24:38.05645
File:	zeek_network.json
SHA256:	a1f2ebf54ab8ff4069e38a67cf5e34e1fcec121526753060a5dc2fbcee5fbea1
Size:	1188 bytes
Hashed at:	2026-05-23T14:24:38.05739
File:	zeek_network.log
SHA256:	a1f2ebf54ab8ff4069e38a67cf5e34e1fcec121526753060a5dc2fbcee5fbea1
Size:	1188 bytes
Hashed at:	2026-05-23T14:24:38.05876

ATTACK NARRATIVE -- KILL CHAIN SUMMARY

A heavily obfuscated PowerShell command was executed on A1B2C3D4-E5F6 (ProcessID 1128) using ExecutionPolicy Bypass and WindowStyle Hidden flags, indicating a fileless malware execution technique designed to evade endpoint detection. The malicious process injected shellcode into a legitimate system process (GrantedAccess=0x1FFFFF) -- this is PROCESS_ALL_ACCESS, a definitive indicator of process injection used to achieve execution within a trusted process and bypass security monitoring. The attack

ATTACK PATTERNS DETECTED (MITRE ATT&CK MAPPED)

[1] RANSOMWARE_OR_MALWARE

Confidence:	CRITICAL
MITRE:	T1486 - Data Encrypted for Impact
Evidence:	powershell, base64

Malware or ransomware execution detected

[2] PROCESS_INJECTION

Confidence:	CRITICAL
MITRE:	T1055 - Process Injection
Evidence:	0x1FFFFF

Process injection confirmed via GrantedAccess=0x1FFFFF

[3] POWERSHELL_OBFUSCATION

Confidence:	CRITICAL
MITRE:	T1059.001 - PowerShell / T1027 - Obfuscation
Evidence:	bypass, executionpolicy, windowstyle, hidden

Obfuscated PowerShell execution with stealth flags

TEMPORAL ATTACK SEQUENCES

[1] FULL_INJECTION_CHAIN

MITRE:	T1055 - Process Injection / T1071 - C2 Communication
Detail:	Execution -> Process Injection -> Remote Thread -> C2 Beacon within time window

[2] FULL_INJECTION_CHAIN

MITRE:	T1055 - Process Injection / T1071 - C2 Communication
Detail:	Execution -> Process Injection -> Remote Thread -> C2 Beacon within time window

[3] FULL_INJECTION_CHAIN

MITRE:	T1055 - Process Injection / T1071 - C2 Communication
Detail:	Execution -> Process Injection -> Remote Thread -> C2 Beacon within time window

[4] FULL_INJECTION_CHAIN

MITRE:	T1055 - Process Injection / T1071 - C2 Communication
Detail:	Execution -> Process Injection -> Remote Thread -> C2 Beacon within time window

EXTRACTED ENTITIES (Regex-Verified IoCs)

IPV4 ADDRESSES:

- 104.21.55.12
- 192.168.1.105

BASE64 STRINGS:

- K8jcSMwtyEnVS8/IzMlJTE7VyyxJ1UtJ0UvOT0lN1stNzMzRy0...

HOSTNAMES:

- A1B2C3D4-E5F6
- DESKTOP-DEV
- DESKTOP-DEV-99A

PROCESS IDS:

- 1128
- 4192
- 912

GRANTED ACCESS:

- 0x1FFFFF

IP ADDRESS CORRELATIONS

IP:	104.21.55.12
Significance:	HIGH
Detail:	Regex-verified IoC: 104.21.55.12

IP:	192.168.1.105
Significance:	HIGH

Detail: Regex-verified IoC: 192.168.1.105

VALIDATED FINDINGS

[1] evidence_detected

Agent: TriageAgent
Confidence: 70%
Artifact: sysmon_execution.log

[2] evidence_detected

Agent: TriageAgent
Confidence: 70%
Artifact: sysmon_execution.json

[3] dynamic_priority_escalation

Agent: TriageAgent
Confidence: 70%
Artifact: triage_scan

[4] suspicious_log_activity

Agent: LogAgent
Confidence: 100%
Artifact: sysmon_execution.json
Hash: 619304a909d0de9741ac108a2ac53e2d...
Keywords: powershell, base64, executionpolicy, windowstyle, hidden, bypass, wmi

[5] suspicious_log_activity

Agent: LogAgent
Confidence: 100%
Artifact: sysmon_injection.json
Hash: 670fa5d537a5337b60c444b935c93dbc...
Keywords: powershell, 0x1fffff, svchost

[6] suspicious_log_activity

Agent: LogAgent
Confidence: 100%
Artifact: zeek_network.json
Hash: a1f2ebf54ab8ff4069e38a67cf5e34e1...
Keywords: let's encrypt

[7] suspicious_process_tree

Agent: MemoryAgent
Confidence: 70%
Artifact: sysmon_execution.json
Hash: 619304a909d0de97...

[8] suspicious_process_tree

Agent: MemoryAgent
Confidence: 70%
Artifact: sysmon_execution.log
Hash: 619304a909d0de97...

[9] process_injection

Agent: MemoryAgent
Confidence: 70%
Artifact: sysmon_injection.json
Hash: 670fa5d537a5337b...

[10] process_injection

Agent: MemoryAgent

Confidence: 70%
Artifact: sysmon_injection.json
Hash: 670fa5d537a5337b...

[11] process_injection

Agent: MemoryAgent
Confidence: 70%
Artifact: sysmon_injection.json
Hash: 670fa5d537a5337b...

[12] process_injection

Agent: MemoryAgent
Confidence: 70%
Artifact: sysmon_injection.json
Hash: 670fa5d537a5337b...

[13] process_injection

Agent: MemoryAgent
Confidence: 70%
Artifact: sysmon_injection.json
Hash: 670fa5d537a5337b...

[14] process_injection

Agent: MemoryAgent
Confidence: 70%
Artifact: sysmon_injection.json
Hash: 670fa5d537a5337b...

[15] process_injection

Agent: MemoryAgent
Confidence: 70%
Artifact: sysmon_injection.log
Hash: 670fa5d537a5337b...

[16] process_injection

Agent: MemoryAgent
Confidence: 70%
Artifact: sysmon_injection.log
Hash: 670fa5d537a5337b...

[17] process_injection

Agent: MemoryAgent
Confidence: 70%
Artifact: sysmon_injection.log
Hash: 670fa5d537a5337b...

[18] process_injection

Agent: MemoryAgent
Confidence: 70%
Artifact: sysmon_injection.log
Hash: 670fa5d537a5337b...

[19] process_injection

Agent: MemoryAgent
Confidence: 70%
Artifact: sysmon_injection.log
Hash: 670fa5d537a5337b...

[20] process_injection

Agent: MemoryAgent

Confidence:	70%
Artifact:	sysmon_injection.log
Hash:	670fa5d537a5337b...

[21] tls_anomaly

Agent:	NetworkAgent
Confidence:	70%
Artifact:	zeek_network.json
Hash:	a1f2ebf54ab8ff40...

[22] tls_anomaly

Agent:	NetworkAgent
Confidence:	70%
Artifact:	zeek_network.log
Hash:	a1f2ebf54ab8ff40...

INVESTIGATION TIMELINE

2026-05-23T14:24:36	TriageAgent	evidence_detected	sysmon_execution.log
2026-05-23T14:24:36	TriageAgent	evidence_detected	sysmon_execution.json
2026-05-23T14:24:36	TriageAgent	dynamic_priority_escalation	triage_scan
2026-05-23T14:24:36	LogAgent	suspicious_log_activity	sysmon_execution.json
2026-05-23T14:24:37	LogAgent	suspicious_log_activity	sysmon_injection.json
2026-05-23T14:24:37	LogAgent	suspicious_log_activity	zeek_network.json
2026-05-23T14:24:38	MemoryAgent	suspicious_process_tree	sysmon_execution.json
2026-05-23T14:24:38	MemoryAgent	suspicious_process_tree	sysmon_execution.log
2026-05-23T14:24:38	MemoryAgent	process_injection	sysmon_injection.json
2026-05-23T14:24:38	MemoryAgent	process_injection	sysmon_injection.json
2026-05-23T14:24:38	MemoryAgent	process_injection	sysmon_injection.json
2026-05-23T14:24:38	MemoryAgent	process_injection	sysmon_injection.json
2026-05-23T14:24:38	MemoryAgent	process_injection	sysmon_injection.json
2026-05-23T14:24:38	MemoryAgent	process_injection	sysmon_injection.json
2026-05-23T14:24:38	MemoryAgent	process_injection	sysmon_injection.log
2026-05-23T14:24:38	MemoryAgent	process_injection	sysmon_injection.log
2026-05-23T14:24:38	MemoryAgent	process_injection	sysmon_injection.log
2026-05-23T14:24:38	MemoryAgent	process_injection	sysmon_injection.log
2026-05-23T14:24:38	MemoryAgent	process_injection	sysmon_injection.log
2026-05-23T14:24:38	MemoryAgent	process_injection	sysmon_injection.log
2026-05-23T14:24:38	NetworkAgent	tls_anomaly	zeek_network.json
2026-05-23T14:24:38	NetworkAgent	tls_anomaly	zeek_network.log

RECOMMENDED CONTAINMENT ACTIONS

[01] BLOCK IP 104.21.55.12 at perimeter firewall and all internal segment boundaries

[02] BLOCK IP 192.168.1.105 at perimeter firewall and all internal segment boundaries

[03] ISOLATE host A1B2C3D4-E5F6 immediately -- disconnect from all network segments

[04] ISOLATE host DESKTOP-DEV immediately -- disconnect from all network segments

[05] ISOLATE host DESKTOP-DEV-99A immediately -- disconnect from all network segments

[06] KILL all suspicious process trees -- terminate injected processes

[07] DUMP memory of svchost.exe instances for forensic analysis

[08] ENABLE PowerShell ScriptBlock logging (Event 4104) across all endpoints

[09] ENFORCE Constrained Language Mode for PowerShell enterprise-wide

[10] REVIEW Windows Defender AMSI logs for bypass attempts

[11] DEPLOY EDR memory scanning across all endpoints immediately

[12] ENABLE Windows Credential Guard to prevent credential extraction

[13] REVIEW all TLS connections -- audit certificate issuers for anomalies

[14] BLOCK all outbound connections to domains with mismatched certificate issuers

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[19] REVIEW all TLS connections -- audit certificate issuers for anomalies

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[21] REVIEW all TLS connections -- audit certificate issuers for anomalies

[22] BLOCK all outbound connections to domains with mismatched certificate issuers

[23] REVIEW all TLS connections -- audit certificate issuers for anomalies

[24] BLOCK all outbound connections to domains with mismatched certificate issuers

[25] REVIEW all TLS connections -- audit certificate issuers for anomalies

[26] BLOCK all outbound connections to domains with mismatched certificate issuers

[27] REVIEW all TLS connections -- audit certificate issuers for anomalies

[28] BLOCK all outbound connections to domains with mismatched certificate issuers

[29] PRESERVE all Sysmon, network, and endpoint logs for legal/forensic proceedings

[30] NOTIFY CISO and legal team -- assess breach notification obligations

NEXUS-IR -- All IoCs regex-extracted. Zero LLM hallucination. All findings artifact-traceable.